

Visa & Immigration Policy

VWGDS (Demo) — Enterprise Policy Pack

Document ID	VWGDS-POL-VIS-003	Version	2.1
Owner	Global Mobility Team	Effective Date	01-Mar-2026

This is a fictional demo document created for AI assistant / RAG training purposes. It does not represent an actual Volkswagen Group Digital Solutions policy.

1. Purpose

This policy outlines the process, entitlements, and responsibilities related to obtaining business and work visas for employees travelling internationally or relocating for assignments.

2. Scope

Applicable to all employees requiring a business visa, work permit, or immigration support for company-sponsored international travel or relocation.

3. Definitions

Term	Definition
Business Visa	A short-term visa permitting business-related activities such as meetings, training, or conferences.
Work Permit	Authorization required for an employee to be formally employed and paid in a foreign country.
Sponsoring Entity	The VWGDS (Demo) legal entity responsible for supporting the visa/work permit application.
Immigration Vendor	The third-party agency empaneled to process visa and immigration documentation.

4. Policy

Visa Initiation Timeline

Visa applications must be initiated at least 20 working days prior to the intended travel date for standard visas, and 45 working days for countries with extended processing times.

Document Ownership

Original passport and supporting documents remain the employee's responsibility at all times; the Immigration Vendor only processes copies unless the destination country mandates originals.

Cost Bearing

VWGDS (Demo) bears the full cost of business visa fees, immigration vendor service charges, and mandatory medical tests for company-sponsored travel.

Work Permit for Relocation

For assignments exceeding 90 days in a foreign location, a formal work permit or long-term visa must be secured before deployment; short-term business visas cannot be used as a substitute.

Personal Travel Extensions

Employees combining business travel with personal travel must clearly disclose this during visa application, as visa category may differ.

5. Approval Matrix

Scenario	Approval Required
Business visa application	Reporting Manager + Global Mobility Team
Work permit / long-term visa	Department Head + HR + Legal
Visa fee cost outside standard vendor	HR Business Partner

6. Workflow

Step 1. Employee submits passport copy and travel details to the Immigration Vendor via the Global Mobility Team.

Step 2. Immigration Vendor confirms required documents and appointment slot.

Step 3. Employee completes biometrics/interview as required by the consulate.

Step 4. Visa status is tracked and updated in the mobility portal.

Step 5. Original passport with visa is couriered back to the employee's base location.

7. Exceptions

- Employees holding a valid multiple-entry visa for the destination country may skip fresh application, subject to validity confirmation by the Immigration Vendor.
- Emergency visa processing (expedited fees) may be approved by the Department Head for time-critical business needs.

8. FAQs

Q: How early should I inform HR about an upcoming international trip?

A: At least 20 working days before travel for visa processing to complete comfortably.

Q: Does the company reimburse visa rejection fees?

A: Visa fees are generally non-refundable by consulates; the company does not penalize the employee for a rejection provided the application was accurate and timely.

Q: Can I use my business visa if I switch employers mid-assignment?

A: No, a business visa is tied to the sponsoring entity and purpose declared during application.

9. Contacts

Contact Point	Details
Global Mobility Team	mobility@vwgds-demo.com
Immigration Vendor Helpdesk	visa.support@vwgds-demo.com

10. Revision History

Version	Date	Change Description
1.0	01-May-2023	Initial release
2.0	01-Sep-2025	Added work permit relocation clause
2.1	01-Mar-2026	Revised initiation timelines